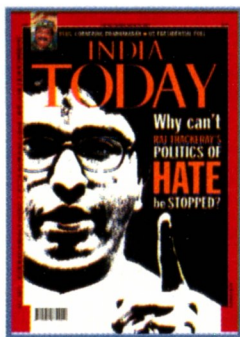


The Politics of Hate

NOVEMBER 10, 2008

Maharashtra Navnirman Sena chief Raj Thackeray's strategy to play to the Maharashtrian gallery is aimed at stealing the vote bank of uncle Bal Thackeray's Shiv Sena, but its ramifications are evil and dangerous.



“ Raj Thackeray and others of his ilk have done enough damage to the unity and integrity of the country and deserve severe punishment. It's incumbent upon the public to isolate such elements and stop their trips to the corridors of power. ”

VIRENDRA KUMAR TANGRI, *on e-mail*

Goon Agenda

The violent attacks in Mumbai against north Indians are condemnable, and the passive attitude of the state Government towards the unconstitutional and violent protests by MNS workers is indeed abhorrent. Raj Thackeray is no longer a toothless cub, but a social terrorist who is following in the footsteps of his own uncle Bal Thackeray. His desperate efforts to carve a niche for himself are creating a storm in the political galaxy. His divisive strategies stand against the spirit of our Constitution and are a deterrent to India's inclusive growth.

SOURMENDRA MITRA, *on e-mail*

To reach the higher echelons of power, the unsaid rule always has been: divide and rule and



Diplomatic Coma

The Joint Anti-Terror Mechanism was a non-starter from the very outset. In fact, Pakistan in all probability knew that it would prove to be fig leaf and a clever ploy to stonewall India's anti-terror moves. The lackadaisical functioning is a mockery of the innocent lives lost in Pak-sponsored terrorist attacks.

ANJUM M. SAMEL, *on e-mail*

Pakistan camouflaged its anti-India stance by lending a helping hand to curb terror activities sponsored by groups across the LoC and India fell for it.

GOVIND SHARMA, *on e-mail*

Thackeray Jr isn't doing anything exceptional. He is reaping rich rewards from the harvest that his uncle Bal Thackeray had sowed in the minds of the Maharashtrians in the late '60s. All said and done, the whole game of hatred against the north Indians in Maharashtra boils down to just votes—of the Marathi *manoos*, for the Marathi *manoos* and by the Marathi *manoos*.

A.K. SHARMA, *Chandigarh*

The genesis of the Raj Thackeray phenomenon is sub-nationalism and not regional or parochial chauvinism. The non-Hindi states in India are virtual sub-nations while Hindi states are quasi-sub-nations. When Maharashtra was formed in 1960, the Gujaratis were the largest among the linguistic mi-

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